4th Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

CONFERENCE PROGRAM

2–4 December, 2026

Venue: Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap, Cambodia

#SAERD26

Website: https://saerdconf.github.io

Economics must serve humanity. We envision an economic thinking that transcends intellectual barriers, reflects reality, and advances the well-being of our global society.

Contact during the conference
Sinoun Him
Email: saerdconf@gmail.com

COMMITTEES

4th Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

Advisory Board

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- Dr. Sothea Oum (Cambodia Australia Partnership for Resilient Economic Development, CAPRED, Cambodia)
- Prof. Penghuy Ngov (Royal University of Phnom Penh, Cambodia)
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- Miss. Sinoun Him (Ministry of Post and Telecommunications, Cambodia)
- Miss. Jakkrya Sey (CDRI)
- Miss. Jenny Symaly (MEF)

CONFERENCE OVERVIEW

4th Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

WEDNESDAY, 2 DECEMBER 2026

13:30 – 14:00	**Registration**				
14:00 – 16:00	**PARALLEL SESSIONS A**				
Room	**A1 · Siem Reap**	**A2 · Angkor Wat**	**A3 · Angkor Thom**	**A4 · Bayon**	**A5 · Bakong**
	Gender, Family and the Household	Migration, Mobility and Livelihoods	Banking, Fintech and Digital Trade	Energy, Minerals and the Green Transition	Trade, Finance and Development
16:00 – 16:30	Break				
16:30 – 16:50	**Introduction to the Young Scholar Initiative**				
16:50 – 17:50	**Edited Book Project**				

THURSDAY, 3 DECEMBER 2026

08:00 – 08:30	**Registration**				
08:30 – 09:10	**Opening and welcome remarks**				
09:10 – 10:00	**Special Lecture**				
10:00 – 10:30	Coffee break				
10:30 – 12:00	**PARALLEL SESSIONS B**				
Room	**B1 · Siem Reap**	**B2 · Angkor Wat**	**B3 · Angkor Thom**	**B4 · Bayon**	**B5 · Bakong**
	Macroeconomy, Firms and Investment	Food Security and Nutrition	Green Finance and Sustainable Development	Public Finance and Taxation	Gender and Economic Opportunity
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch				
13:00 – 15:00	**PARALLEL SESSIONS C**				
Room	**C1 · Siem Reap**	**C2 · Angkor Wat**	**C3 · Angkor Thom**	**C4 · Bayon**	**C5 · Bakong**
	Informality and Social Protection	Value Chains and Inequality	Rural Finance and Sustainable Farming	Agriculture, Food and Rural Livelihoods	Education, Skills and Higher Education
15:00 – 15:30	Coffee break				
15:30 – 16:50	**Panel Discussion A**				
19:00 – 21:00	**Dinner**				

FRIDAY, 4 DECEMBER 2026

08:30 – 10:30	**PARALLEL SESSIONS D**			
Room	**D1 · Siem Reap**	**D2 · Angkor Wat**	**D3 · Angkor Thom**	**D4 · Bayon**
	Labour Markets and Demography	Public Policy and Food Security	Labour, Culture and Economic Thought	Trade, Institutions and Development
10:00 – 10:30	Coffee break			
10:30 – 12:00	**Panel Discussion B**			
12:15 – 13:00	Lunch			
13:00 – 15:00	**PARALLEL SESSIONS E**			
Room	**E1 · Siem Reap**	**E2 · Angkor Wat**	**E3 · Angkor Thom**	**E4 · Bayon**
	Digital Economy and Inclusion	Health, Nutrition and Climate Shocks	Urban, Tourism and Spatial Economics	Climate, Water and Environment
15:00 – 15:30	Coffee break			
15:30 – 16:00	**Special session**			
16:00 – 16:30	**Closing remarks**			
19:00 – 21:00	**Dinner**			

WEDNESDAY, 2 DECEMBER 2026

4th Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

Venue: Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap, Cambodia

13:30 – 14:00	**Registration**
14:00 – 16:00	**Parallel Sessions A** *Five sessions run at the same time – see the "Parallel A" pages*
16:00 – 16:30	*Break*
16:30 – 16:50	**Introduction to the Young Scholar Initiative** *Sokhimmarya Chea (YSI)* *Sinoun Him (YSI)* *Jenny Symaly (YSI)*
16:50 – 17:50	**Edited Book Project** ***Asian Developing Region*** *Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth (Saitama University, Japan)* *Dr. Sattwick Dey Biswas (YSI/INET)*

THURSDAY, 3 DECEMBER 2026

4th Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

Venue: Pañ̃ñāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap, Cambodia

08:00 – 08:30 **Registration**

08:30 – 09:10 **Opening and welcome remarks**

Dr. Ratha Chiv, Executive Vice Chancellor, Pañ̃ñāsāstra University of Cambodia (PUC), Siem Reap Campus, Cambodia

H.E. Dr. Kao Thach, ARDB, Cambodia

09:10 – 10:00 **Special Lecture**

Graduating from Least Developed Country Status: How Cambodia Can Prepare for a Smooth and Sustainable Transition

Speaker

Prof. Matthew McCartney (Cambodia Development Resource Institute, Cambodia)

10:00 – 10:30 *Coffee break*

10:30 – 12:00 **Parallel Sessions B**

Five sessions run at the same time – see the "Parallel B" pages

12:00 – 13:00 *Lunch*

13:00 – 15:00 **Parallel Sessions C**

Five sessions run at the same time – see the "Parallel C" pages

15:00 – 15:30 *Coffee break*

15:30 – 16:50 **Panel Discussion A**

ARDB: Agriculture and Rural Financing

Speakers

TBD

Moderator

Asso. Prof. Penghuy Ngov (Royal University of Phnom Penh, Cambodia)

19:00 – 21:00 **Dinner**

Venue: TBD

FRIDAY, 4 DECEMBER 2026

4th Southeast Asia Economic Research and Development Conference

Venue: Paññāsāstra University of Cambodia, Siem Reap, Cambodia

08:30 – 10:30	**Parallel Sessions D** *Five sessions run at the same time – see the "Parallel D" pages*
10:00 – 10:30	*Coffee break*
10:30 – 12:00	**Panel Discussion B** ***Economic Growth and Sectoral Transformation in Developing Economies*** ***Speakers*** *Prof. Micheal Hill (State University of New York, United States)* *Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth (Saitama University, Japan)* *Asso. Prof. Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam (University of Malaya, Malaysia)* *Moderator* *H.E. Dr. Un Kheang, Secretary of State, Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation (MFAIC)*
12:15 – 13:00	*Lunch*
13:00 – 15:00	**Parallel Sessions E** *Five sessions run at the same time – see the "Parallel E" pages*
15:00 – 15:30	*Coffee break*
15:30 – 16:00	**Special session** *Best Paper Award*
16:00 – 16:30	**Closing remarks** *The Conference Organizing Committee*
19:00 – 21:00	**Dinner** *Venue: TBD*

SPEAKERS' BIOS

H.E. Dr. Kao Thach

ARDB, Cambodia · Opening and welcome remarks



His Excellency Dr. KAO Thach, Delegate of Royal Government of Cambodia in charge as Chief Executive Officer and a member of the Board of Directors of ARDB.

In addition to his current duties, he is a member of the Supreme National Economic Council, with equivalent rank to the Secretary of State, and an arbitrator of the Arbitration Council. Prior to joining ARDB, H.E was a Deputy Director General of the Securities and Exchange Commission of Cambodia with the equivalent rank as the Under-Secretary of State (in charge of the Department of Legal Affairs and the Intermediary Inspection Department), formerly the Chief of Office of the Financial Marketing at the Department of Financial Industry and Member of the Technical Working Group on Financial sector, representing the Ministry of Economy and Finance under the ASEAN Framework for Capital Market Development such as ABMI, ACMF and Financial Services Liberalization.

H.E has been involved in drafting the Law on Public Securities and the Law on the Issuance and Trading of Non-government Securities, as well as being a member of the working group in charge of preparing the financial sector development strategy from 2006 to 2015 and 2011 to 2020. From 1999 to 2003 he was a legal officer at the Ministry of Justice and a clerk in Koh Kong province.

For his academic background, H.E received his PhD in Public Policy from the University of Cambodia (Cambodia) in 2021, completed the dissertation in “The Role of Securities Regulators in Efficient Supervision and Regulation of the Securities Market in Cambodia” and his PhD in Administration. Business (DBA) from EU Business School (Switzerland) in 2018.

H.E obtained a master’s degree in Law from Bond University (Australia) in 2002, majoring in International Trade Law System, WTO Legal Framework, Dispute Resolution, and Dispute Design

H.E. Dr. Un Kheang

Secretary of State, Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation (MFAIC), Cambodia · Moderator, Panel Discussion B



Dr. Un Kheang is a distinguished Cambodian diplomat, scholar, and public policy expert. He currently serves as Secretary of State at the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation of the Kingdom of Cambodia. He is also Chairman of the Board of Directors of the Akkak Pundit Sapheachar AUN Pornmoniroth Center for Public Policy Studies and Training and a Board Member of the Cambodia Development Center.

Before joining the Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation in 2023, Dr. Un was an award-winning Professor of Political Science at Northern Illinois University (NIU) in the United States and a Chair Professor at the School of International Relations and Southeast Asian Studies at Xiamen University under China’s High-Level Foreign Talents Program.

Dr. Un, a widely respected scholar in political science, international relations, and Southeast Asian studies, has published extensively in leading international journals and academic presses. His scholarly achievements have earned him prestigious fellowships and research appointments, including those from the Canberra Fellowships Program (CFP), the Fulbright Program, the Royal Netherlands Institute of Southeast Asian and Caribbean Studies (KITLV), the Center for Khmer Studies, and the Center for Asian Democracy at the University of Louisville.

Internationally recognized for his expertise in Southeast Asia, diplomacy, and global affairs, Dr. Un has delivered lectures and participated in policy dialogues at leading universities, research



Dr. Ratha Chiv

Dr. Chiv Ratha, an Executive Vice Chancellor & PUCSR Board Member, is an experienced leader with a strong background in both the public and private sectors. He has served in various significant roles, including Deputy Secretary-General of the Cambodia National Youth Council and Deputy Director General of Youth at the Ministry of Education, Youth, and Sports. With over two decades of expertise in youth development, strategic
leadership, policy development, and legislative drafting, Dr. Chiv has played a vital role in shaping national programs and policies.Additionally, he has a solid academic background, having served as Dean of the Faculty of Tourism and Hospitality Management and the Faculty of Business Administration at Pannasastra University of Cambodia. He holds a Ph.D. in Leadership, an MBA from Monash University, and a Bachelor of Pharmacy. Dr. Chiv is also actively involved in part-time lecturing and has diverse skills in leadership, education, event planning, customer service, and stakeholder collaboration.

Prof. Matthew McCartney

Cambodia Development Resource Institute, Cambodia · Special Lecture (Day 2)



Professor Dr Matthew McCartney is the Chief Economist at the Cambodia Development Resouece Institute (CDRI). He brings over 25 years of experience as an international development advisor (World Bank, USAid. EU. UNDP), a Professor at SOAS, the University of Oxford, and the Africa Urban Lab (AUL) in Zanzibar, and as a researcher who has interacted with partners in UK and global south Universities, think tanks, donors, grant-funders, NGOs, and government. Matthew has conducted development consultancy work in Bangladesh, Azerbaijan, Zambia, Botswana, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Georgia, Saudi Arabia, and Jordan; and has been a visiting Professor at Universities in Pakistan, India, Japan, South Korea, Poland, Zambia, and Belgium. Matthew is an economist specializing in issues of economic development, economic growth, special economic zones (SEZs), big infrastructure, urbanization, the resource curse, technology, industrialization and the role of the state, with a particular focus on the South Asian region (especially India, Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, and Pakistan), Africa (Tanzania, Zambia, and Ethiopia), the economics of the Chinese Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), and human development issues relating to nutrition, employment, education, poverty, and inequality. Matthew has published eight books (Cambridge University Press, Oxford University Press, Palgrave, and Routledge) fifteen peer-review journal articles and fifteen book chapters. His next book is focused on industrialization and the impact of China in Ethiopia and Zambia. Industrialisation, China, and the Developmental State: A Comparative Study of Governance in Ethiopia and Zambia, 2000-2020 and will be published by Routledge in 2026. Matthew holds a BSc (Economics) from the University of Cambridge, an MPhil (Economics) from the University of Oxford,

Prof. Micheal Hill

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State University of New York, United States · Panel Discussion B

Biography to be announced.

Prof. Sovannroeun Samreth



Saitama University, Japan · Edited Book Project (Day 1) and Panel Discussion B

Sovannroeun Samreth holds a Ph.D. from Kyoto University, Japan. He currently serves as a Professor at the Faculty of Liberal Arts and Graduate School of Humanities and Social Sciences, Saitama University, Japan. He is also a Senior Visiting Fellow at the Cambodia Development Resource Institute. His research interests include microfinance, political economy, and development issues in Cambodia and other developing countries. His research outcome has contributed to policy discussions on dollarization, interest rate ceiling, financial literacy, financial inclusion, and household welfare in Cambodia.

Asso. Prof. Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam



University of Malaya, Malaysia · Panel Discussion B

Associate Professor Dr. Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam received his PhD (Economics) with emphasis on Labour Economics from Universiti Putra Malaysia and his Masters of Commerce (Economics) from University of Wollongong, New South Wales, Australia. His research interest is concentrated on Labour Economics and Economic Development focusing on Southeast Asia. He was a Visiting Researcher at the Warwick Institute for Employment Research, University of Warwick, United Kingdom from November 2014 to October 2015.

Asso. Prof. Penghuy Ngov

Royal University of Phnom Penh, Cambodia · Panel Discussion B

Dr. NGOV Penghuy is currently an Associate Professor at the Royal University of Phnom Penh, where he teaches Development Economics and International Economics. His areas of expertise include sustainable development, poverty reduction, free trade agreements, trade negotiations, and least developed country (LDC) graduation. Beyond his academic role, Dr. Penghuy actively contributes to the community on a pro bono basis. He serves as the Chairman of the Board of Directors of the Japan Alumni of Cambodia and as a Director of Asia Japan Alumni.



Dr. Penghuy earned his Ph.D. and Master's degree in International Development from Nagoya University, Japan, and his Bachelor's degree in Economics from Fukui Prefectural University, Japan. He previously held several academic and leadership positions at Nagoya University, including Assistant Professor (2008–2014), and later Director and Designated Associate Professor at the Asian Satellite Campus Institutes (2014–2025). In addition to his academic work, Dr. Penghuy provides consultancy services to development partners and governments across the region. His expertise covers trade policy analysis, free trade agreements, trade preferences, project evaluation, and capacity building.

His recent publications and professional contributions include:

Ngov, Penghuy, and Chheng, Savuth. 2025. Structural Transformation and Economic Growth in Cambodia. Cambodia's New Growth Strategy: An Assessment of Medium- and Long-term Growth for Resilient, Inclusive, and Sustainable Development. Background Paper No. 02. Phnom Penh: CDRI.
Oum, Sothea, Thangavelu, Shandre, and Ngov, Penghuy. 2024. "Service Sector Development in Cambodia: Employment Choice and Household Consumption of Services." In Services Global Supply Chains in ASEAN and East Asia, 253-280. Singapore: Springer.
Yeth, Vinel, Oum, Youthy, and Ngov, Penghuy, eds. 2023. Public Financial Management: Cambodian

Dr. Sattwick Dey Biswas

YSI/INET · Edited Book Project (Day 1)



Sattwick Dey Biswas is an independent researcher, Guest Faculty member, and Department Coordinator in the Department of Social Work at Kanyashree University, West Bengal, a newly established state university. He also serves as one of the four Academic Coordinators of the University.

He earned his doctorate (Dr. rer. pol.) in 2019 from the School of Spatial Planning, TU Dortmund University, Germany, where his research focused on land acquisition, compensation, and the political economy of valuation. His doctoral thesis was published as Land Acquisition and Compensation in India: Mysteries of Valuation (Palgrave Macmillan, 2020) and has since informed scholarly debates on land policy, valuation practices, and social justice in the Global South. He holds a Master's degree in Social Work (MSW) and a Bachelor's degree in Social Work (BSW) from Visva-Bharati University, as well as a second Master's degree in International Social Welfare and Health Policy from Oslo Metropolitan University, Norway.

Dey Biswas's research spans land policy, social policy, political economy, and the history of economic thought, with particular emphasis on plural values, property regimes, welfare institutions, and capitalist transformations in the Global South. He has published in leading international journals including Land Use Policy, Environment and Planning C, Town Planning Review, Social Policy and Society, History of Economic Thought and Policy, and the International Review of Economics. He is the editor and co-editor of scholarly volumes, including The Politics of Welfare in the Global South

WEDNESDAY, 2 DECEMBER 2026

PARALLEL SESSIONS A 14:00 – 16:00

Siem Reap · A1

GENDER, FAMILY AND THE HOUSEHOLD

Chair: Islam Gul (SBS Radio Australia)

How Gender Norms Shape Labor Market Outcomes for Women in Pakistan's Industrial Sector?
Islam Gul (SBS Radio Australia) and M. Rehan

Negotiating Identity, Belonging, and Survival: A Phenomenological Study of Domestic Abuse among LGBTQ+ Survivors in Mindanao, Philippines
Dirb Boy Sebrero (JH Cerilles State College)

Women's Perceptions on the Climate Change impacted their livelihoods: the preparedness strategy for the adaptation to climate change
Sokha Rang (Ministry of Environment) and Hout Khieu

Gender Gaps and Vulnerabilities in Climate-Resilient Agricultural Governance in Cambodia
Uon Sokmoly (Cambodia Development Resource Institute), Sonia Akter, Sim Sokcheng, Sey Jakkrya, and Yiyi Zhao

Angkor Wat · A2

MIGRATION, MOBILITY AND LIVELIHOODS

Chair: Soumya Mitra (North Bengal St. Xaviers College)

Multi-Driver Dynamics of Climate-Linked Out-Migration in the Indian Himalayas
Aayush Shah (Indian Institute of Technology Madras) and Krish Malakar

Balancing Marine Conservation and Local Livelihoods: Evidence on the socio-economic effects of Marine Protected Areas in Vietnam
Anh Nguyen (Fulbright University Vietnam)

The nexus between youth involvement in education and irregular migration to South Africa in Hadiya, Ethiopia: Situational and Impact Analysis
Mengistu Girma Tirore (Wachemo University), Mihretu Wondimu, and Nega Jibat

Living on the Margins: Livelihood Vulnerability of Migrant Informal Labourers in Sikkim Himalaya
Soumya Mitra (North Bengal St. Xaviers College) and Subham Dey Sarkar

Angkor Thom · A3

BANKING, FINTECH AND DIGITAL TRADE

Chair: Rido Thath (Royal University of Phnom Penh)

Financial Infrastructure and Banking-Sector Performance in Cambodia: Evidence from Physical and Digital Financial Development (2008–2023)
Hak Sokly (Build Bright University)

Recalibrating Digital Trade: Measures and Strategies for Comprehensive Trade Frameworks in ASEAN Economy
Arvy Osma (Mariners Polytechnic Colleges Foundation of Canaman Cam Sur)

A Study on Financial Literacy Among University Students in Cambodia
Rido Thath (Royal University of Phnom Penh), Pet Lika, They Vannthout, Ourk Sanchhay, and Ny Chhoryi

RCEP Cross-border E-commerce and Rural Income Inequality: Evidence from Thailand's Digital Transformation
Kinza Malik (Shaanxi Normal University) and Idiongo-Abasi Sunday Peter

Bayon · A4

ENERGY, MINERALS AND THE GREEN TRANSITION

Chair: Leandro Estadilla (University of Santo Tomas)

Macroeconomic Determinants of Renewable Energy Production in Selected Southeast Asian Countries
Leandro Estadilla (University of Santo Tomas) and Ronaldo Cabauatan

Impact of Nickel Downstreaming on Inclusive Green Growth and Regional Spillover Effects in Sulampua
Baiq Try Zulmeida (Statistics Indonesia)

Suffering Amid Abundance: Nickel Downstreaming, Capital Reproduction, and Ecological Crimes in North Maluku
Bapthista Mario Yosryandi Sara (Universitas Nasional)

Bakong · A5

TRADE, FINANCE AND DEVELOPMENT

Chair: Sothea Oum (CAPRED, Cambodia)

Trade Diversion Effects of the US - China Trade Wars on Vietnam: A Gravity Model Approach
Ally Nguyen (Adelaide University)

Digital Payments, Institutional Governance, and Islamic Bank Performance in Developing Markets: Dynamic Panel Evidence
Zuhairan Yunmi Yunan (Universiti Malaya)

Post-Conflict Development and Digital Transformation in the Global South: Education, Innovation, and Democratic
Somaiya Padilla (University of the Philippines Diliman)

Fiscal Policy Architecture and Economic Growth: A Cross-National Panel Analysis Using World Development Indicators
Elish Heng (Paragon International University) and Pahlaj Moolio

Siem Reap · B1

MACROECONOMY, FIRMS AND INVESTMENT

Chair: Sovannroeun Samreth (Saitama University)

Vulnerability and Resilience: The Vietnamese Economy Facing Global Instability - Insights from An Empirical SFC Model
Xuan Huy Pham (University of Rouen Normandy), Luis Reyes, and Arsène Rieber

Uneven Competition, Financial Constraints, and Adaptive Responses: Firm-Level Evidence from Southeast Asia
Usman Alhassan (Ritsumeikan University Japan)

Institutional Quality and Foreign Direct Investment: A Sectoral Analysis of Southeast Asia
Panhaboth Phat (Non-Bank Financial Services Authority) and Hoeurn Cheb

Angkor Wat · B2

FOOD SECURITY AND NUTRITION

Chair: Seakleng Leang (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank)

Food Security in Cambodia from 1993 to 2025: A Critical Review of Trends, Challenges, and Policy Interventions
Seakleng Leang (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank), Chenda Ken, Chansereyvuth Bun, Channda Kean, Dysavath Chhit, and Nouv Thai

The Relationship Between Sustainable Development and Resilient Agriculture: A Case Study of Preah Vihear Province, Cambodia
Vantha Thuon (Royal University of Agriculture)

The Role of Agri-Food Processing in Improving Food Security in Cambodia: A Qualitative Study of Cashew, Vegetable, and Mango Value Chains
Vandy Sak (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank)

Angkor Thom · B3

GREEN FINANCE AND SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT

Chair: Sunetra Ghatak (O.P. Jindal Global University)

Innovation under Uncertainty: Structural Thresholds for Green Growth in BRICS Countries
Sunetra Ghatak (O.P. Jindal Global University)

Green Finance, Innovation, and Financial Stability: Assessing the Role of Sustainable Investment in South Africa's Transition Economy
Bongumusa Ngema (Cape Peninsula University of Technology), Linda Paul, and Ravinder Rena

Renewable Energy Adoption in India's Transport and Manufacturing Sectors: An Economy-Wide and Distributional Assessment Using a Recursive-Dynamic E3-CGE Model
Rajat Kumar (Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee), Rishman Jot Kaur Chahal, and Amit Agarwal

Bayon · B4

PUBLIC FINANCE AND TAXATION

Chair: Jenny Symaly (MEF)

Institutions and urban fiscal capacity: Evidence from property taxation in India
Abhishek Seth (Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee) and Manish K. Singh

Preventing Rather than Curing: Fiscal Rules and the Sub-national Liquidity Stress
Akhila Balagopalan (Central University of Kerala) and Syam Prasad

Converging yields, rising debts: Fiscal spillovers in a decentralized economy
Swayamshree Barik (Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee) and Manish K Singh

Bakong · B5

GENDER AND ECONOMIC OPPORTUNITY

Chair: Thirunaukarasu Subramaniam (University of Malaya)

Explore how gender stereotypes influence academic field selections and career ambitions among Cambodian university
Sengthai Lay (University of South-East Asia)

They Were Never Asked: Youth Voices, Reproductive Governance, and the Missing Link Between Economic Opportunity and Women's Agency in Rural Southeast Asia
Febroza Belda (Population Connection) and Hanh Evans

Caught Between Education and Unpaid Work: A Study of Gender Inequality among Students in India
Shruti Priya (Institute for Social and Economic Change) and Indrajit

THURSDAY, 3 DECEMBER 2026

PARALLEL SESSIONS C 13:00 – 15:00

Siem Reap · C1

INFORMALITY AND SOCIAL PROTECTION

Chair: Manish Bharti (Central University of Jammu)

Who Does Social Insurance Exclude? A Qualitative Inquiry into Youth Informality and Social Protection Design in Indonesia
Holongi Sitorus (Universitas Sumatera Utara)

Buddhist Institutions as Informal Social Protection Safety Nets in Ladakh
Manish Bharti (Central University of Jammu)

Beyond Neoliberal and Populist Perspectives: Class Differentiation and Reproduction among Street Vendors in Indonesia's Urban Informal Economy
Ismada Firdaus Mandala Putra (Universitas Gadjah Mada)

Beyond the State: Informal Institutions and the Social Foundations of Economic Resilience in Asia
Hosna Salimi (University of Tehran)

Angkor Wat · C2

VALUE CHAINS AND INEQUALITY

Chair: Gerhardt Kalterherberg (Darmstadt and Boston University)

Stuck in the Middle: Evidence of Smile Curve in Global Garment Industry
Cheapiseth Sam (Royal University of Phnom Penh) and Cheb Hoeurn

Does Northern Prosperity Depend on Southern Labour? Wage Costs, Labour Time, and Global Value-Chain Exposure
Niall Reddy (University of the Witwatersrand) and Virgilio Urbi Lazardi

The Role of Economic Diplomacy in Agricultural Exports: Comparative Studies and Lesson for Cambodia
Busta Sorn (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank), Eang Meymey, Heng Sokvatey, Kean Channda, Heav Tithrata, and Nguon Sambathvirya

Bypassing the Credit Crunch: A Policy Sandbox Test of Non-Bank Trade Liquidity
Gerhardt Kalterherberg (Darmstadt and Boston University) and Clément Berthou

Angkor Thom · C3

RURAL FINANCE AND SUSTAINABLE FARMING

Chair: Dara Chea (Future Forum)

Factors Influencing Loan Repayment among Rice Farmers: Evidence from Ba Phnom and Moung Reussei Districts, Cambodia.
Soksambath Nguon (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank), Sak Vandy, Chhit Dysavath, Bun Chansereyvuth, and Tuy Puli

Innovative Financing for Climate Risk Among Smallholder Farmers: The Case Study in Cambodia
Chankreusna Ieng (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank), Tepsopheaktra Khim, Chruk Sang, Sotheara Theang, and Somnnang San

Understanding Sustainable Agricultural Practices Adoption among Smallholder Leafy Vegetable Farmers in Cambodia: Socio-
Muyhui Hong (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank), Chheanhuy Hok, Nita Chamroeun, and Sreyneath Sara

"We Plant the Trees, They Get the Fees": Bridging the Missing Middle for Smallholders in Indonesia and Cambodia's Carbon Markets
Bima Rafly Fachrezzi (State Islamic University of Sunan Ampel Surabaya)

Bayon · C4

AGRICULTURE, FOOD AND RURAL LIVELIHOODS

Chair: Dalin Ly (MAFF, Cambodia)

Addressing Nutrition Knowledge Inequality among Young Women in Nepal through Educational Intervention: An Explanatory Mixed-Method Study
Alisha Dahal (Pokhara University) and Arun Kumar Koirala

Do Financial and Productive Assets Buffer Cambodian Farm Households from Climate Shocks? Evidence from Food-Security Outcomes in 2023 and 2024
Ivan Harris Tanyag (University of the Philippines, Diliman)

Public Policies, Cooperativism, and Agroecology in Argentina (2011–2024): An Analysis of Institutional Patterns
Nadia Rovelli (Di Tella University)

Using Hypothetical Auctions to predict farmer responses in a market-based conservation program
Panha Socheat (Agricultural and Rural Development Bank) and Emiel De

Bakong · C5

EDUCATION, SKILLS AND HIGHER EDUCATION

Chair: Minali Grover (O.P. Jindal Global University)

Cambodia's Future Education: Policy Options for A Lifelong Learning Ecosystem
Dara Chea (Future Forum)

School Resource Development and Learning Outcomes: Evidence from a Comprehensive Upgrading Program in Cambodia
Socheath Eng (Independent Researcher)

From Classrooms to Careers: The Impact of Fee Reimbursement Scheme on Education and Employment
Minali Grover (O.P. Jindal Global University) and Ajay Sharma

From Internationalization Rationales to Collaboration Rationales: An Institution-Level Framework for Explaining Why Higher Education Institutions Collaborate Internationally
Vijyeta Bhankhariya (Nirma University), Punit Saurabh, and Yashraj

Siem Reap · D1

LABOUR MARKETS AND DEMOGRAPHY

Chair: Penghuy Ngov (Royal University of Phnom Penh, Cambodia)

Who Bears the Risk? A Household Risk Exposure Index for South and Southeast Asia
Nitesh Kumar (Northeastern University)

Labour Force Participation among Older Adults in Brunei: A Cross-Sectional Study
Valatheeswaran Chinnakkannu (Universiti Brunei Darussalam)

Brain Drain in the Digital Age: An Experimental Investigation of Technostress, AI Anxiety, and Economic Opportunity
Van Trung Nguyen (National Cheng Kung University), Luong Dinh Thien Duc, and Lee-Anne Cassandra Johennesse

Trapped in Hope: What Influences Persistence and Continuity of Migrant Workers in Digital Labour Platforms in Urban India?
Kinchan Chakma (Indian Institute of Technology Bombay) and Rahul Sapkal

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Megha Susan Philip (Institute for Social and Economic Change)

Combating VAT Fraud and Avoidance in ASEAN: Comparative Lessons from South Korea and Taiwan on Regulatory and Technological Frameworks
Hanh Nguyen Phuong (National Economics University)

The Role of Community Grain Banks in Household Food Security Outcomes: A Mixed-Methods Study from Rural India
Vaishali Sharma (Bennett University)

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Muhammad Abdulaziz Muhammad (Bayero University Kano), Kamal Tasiu Abdullahi, and Amine Chentouf

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Ly Quoc Dang (Can Tho University), Alexander M. Cannon, Ly Hung, and Danh An

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Pirom Khiev (Cambodia Development Resource Institute), Sokmoly Uon, and Miwa Kana

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Menghak Chhun (Future Forum)

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Hanafi Kholifatul Iman (Hiroshima University)

Regional Development, Public Infrastructure and Wealth Inequality: Evidence from the Dravidian Development Model of Tamil Nadu
Manimadan Alagesan (Indian Institute of Technology Madras) and Binitha V Thampi

Gendered Environmental Education for Strengthening Climate Resilience in Community-Based Tourism: A Case Study of the Tam Giang Lagoon, Vietnam
Nguyet Tran (University of Agriculture and Forestry, Hue University) and

Bayon · E4

CLIMATE, WATER AND ENVIRONMENT

Chair: Rani Destia Wahyuningsih (Universitas Gadjah Mada)

Groundwater Depletion in Lahore: Policy Challenges and Sustainable Water Governance
Humna Mohsin (Government College University Lahore) and Siddra Noor

Groundwater Depletion in Lahore
Siddra Noor (Government College University Lahore) and Humna Mohsin

Living with Heat: Evidence on the Mental Health Consequences of Temperature Exposure from an Equatorial Country
Rani Destia Wahyuningsih (Universitas Gadjah Mada) and Elan Satriawan

Climate-Induced Migration and the Future of Global Trade: Legal and Economic Risks in Southeast Asia with a Focus on Indonesia
Abdulkadir Aminu Bichi (Universitas Islam Indonesia)

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